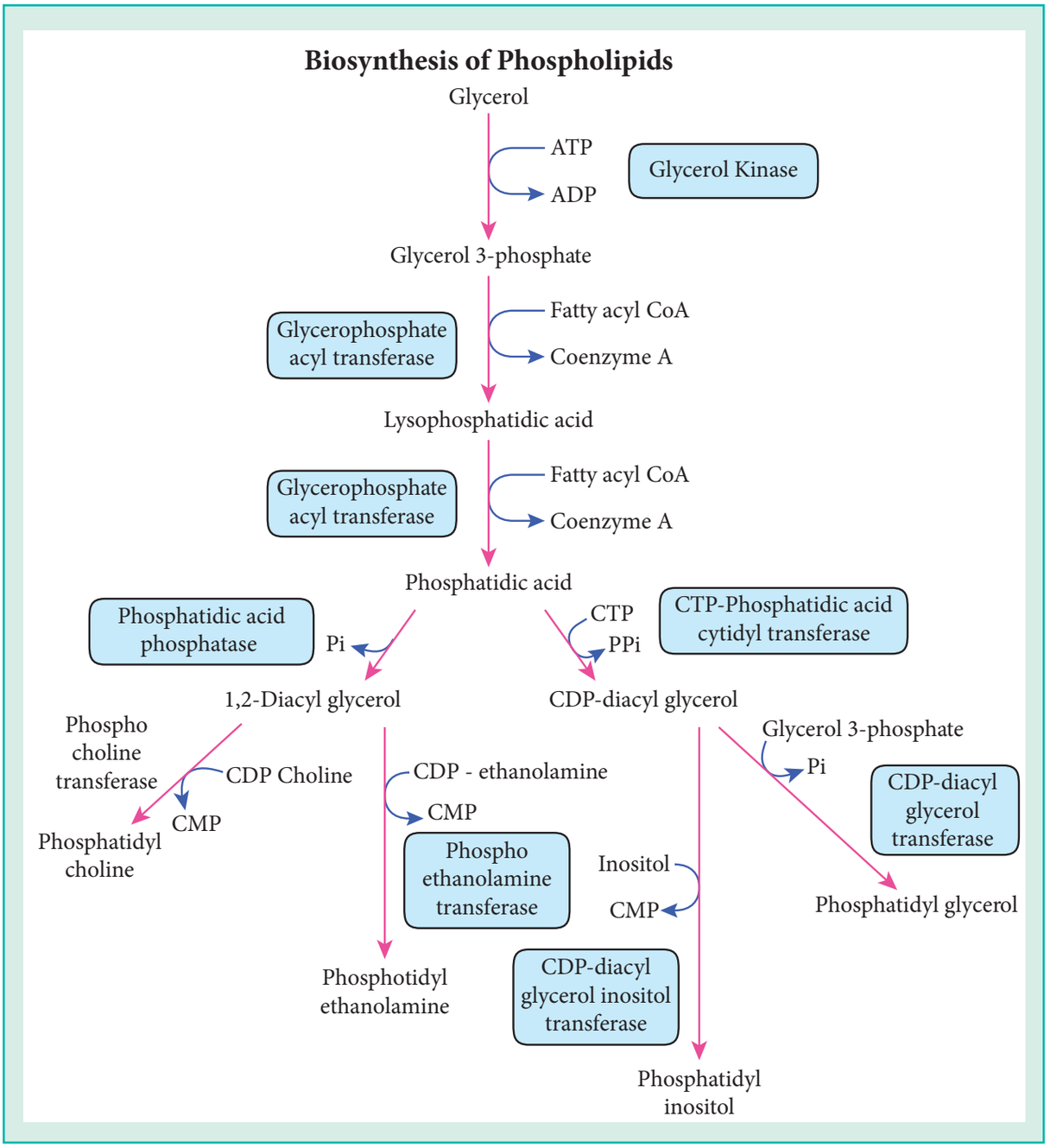


5.5.3 Biosynthesis of lecithin

Lecithin (phosphatidylcholine) is a precursor for choline. It is involved in the synthesis of the neurotransmitter acetylcholine. Lecithin is also involved in complex intracellular processes, including the regulation of cellular membrane permeability.

Most of the reactions of lecithin biosynthesis occurs in the endoplasmic reticulum. The principal pathway of lecithin biosynthesis uses cytidine diphosphate choline(CDP-choline). CDP-choline is formed from the reaction of CTP with phosphocholine, which is obtained by the phosphorylation of choline.

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